



Web-based Platforms for Localisation

Previous articles in this series have explored how to localise the application user interface using Desktop software. This article covers localising using Web-based platforms, which are easier and convenient, as contributors do not have to worry about file formats, translation memories, version management systems, etc. These are expressly designed as Translation Management Systems, allowing multiple team members to collaborate on a project.

The features of web based platforms include display of localisation status and statistics of all the files of a project, support for translation memories and workflow management. Glossaries are also supported in some of the tools. Let us look at Launchpad.net, Pootle for LibreOffice, and Translatewiki.net as three examples.

Launchpad.net

This is one of the well-known Web-based localisation platforms. On visiting the site, you will learn that it supports

334 languages and has 64,938 translators in 43 translation groups. It was started by Canonical in 2005, and released as open source in 2009. Its translation tool is called Rosetta. It is much more than a localisation platform, as it supports code hosting with version control, release management, bug tracking, mailing lists and wikis. The translation feature provides a summary view of the status of localisation, and features suggestions from the vast translation memory. It can be used for localising operating systems and independent projects. If a package uses Launchpad.net as the upstream (the root place for managing the project), users can just do the localisation. If the upstream is different, then, after completing the localisation,



Figure 1: Using Launchpad.net to localise WUBI

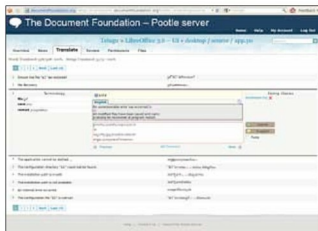


Figure 2: LibreOffice localisation using Pootle